
BBC LEARNING ENGLISH

6 Minute English worksheet

Was Christmas better in the past?



Listen to the full episode here: <https://bbc.in/4iJrPK1>

1. Look at the cover image and title of the episode. What do you think this episode is about? What do you know about this topic already? What vocabulary do you associate with this topic?

2. Now listen to the first two minutes of the episode.

- What do the presenters say the episode is about?
- What is this week's question? What do you think the answer is?

3. Now listen to the whole episode. As you listen, write down the six items of vocabulary. What do they mean?

a) Word/phrase: _____

It means: _____.

b) Word/phrase: _____

It means: _____.

c) Word/phrase: _____

It means: _____.

d) Word/phrase: _____

It means: _____.

e) Word/phrase: _____

It means: _____.

f) Word/phrase: _____

It means: _____.

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4. What did you learn that was surprising or new in this episode?

5. Answer the quiz questions. Listen again or use the transcript to help you.

1. Which of these is not a UK Christmas tradition?
 - a) putting out a drink and snack for Father Christmas
 - b) having a cup of tea on Christmas Eve
 - c) eating roast turkey on Christmas Day

2. What does nostalgia mean?
 - a) feeling happy and also sad when thinking about the past
 - b) feeling happy and also sad when thinking about the future
 - c) feeling happy and also sad when thinking about the present

3. What does psychology professor Daryl O'Connor do every Christmas with his children?
 - a) The children queue up on the stairs while Daryl checks for Santa Claus.
 - b) Daryl waits on the stairs while the children check for Santa Claus.
 - c) They knock on the door to check for Santa Claus.

4. "It's so hot today, I'm _____ a cold drink."
 - a) resting for
 - b) dying for
 - c) wanting for

5. What means the purpose of something?
 - a) rose-tinted
 - b) frame
 - c) function

6. Which word means to think of or describe something in a certain way?
 - a) rose-tinted
 - b) frame
 - c) function

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6. Write your own sentences using the vocabulary.

7. Answer the following questions.

- What are three things you have learnt from this episode?
- How does this topic make you feel?
- Give three examples relevant to your life using the vocabulary.

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Answers

3.

- a. nostalgia – a feeling a happiness and also some sadness when you think about a thing that happened in the past
- b. indeed (+do in the present simple) – yes, used to agree
- c. dying for (something) – really want (something)
- d. rose-tinted – seeing only the positive parts of something and not the negative parts
- e. function - purpose
- f. frame - think of or describe as

5. 1b, 2a, 3a, 4b, 5c, 6b

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Teacher's notes

This worksheet is standardised so that you can amend and use it as appropriate with your classes.

Some topics may be difficult for learners, especially those which could be upsetting or cause offence. Please be mindful of this when using this worksheet and adapt it as necessary.

Extension activities

- Role-play an interview with an 'interviewer' and an 'expert' on this topic.
- Write a short story or article using the vocabulary from this episode.
- Read original articles on this topic.
- For homework: If it is available in your country, download and listen to the original podcast these extracts were taken from.